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CUET UG

Geography

Human Geography: Nature and Scope

Fundamentals of Human Geography: Epistemology, Dualism, Paradigms, Evolution, and Disciplinary Sub-fields

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Module 1: The Disciplinary Genesis & Epistemological Foundations

1.1 The Nature and Scope of Geography as an Integrative Discipline

Geography is an all-embracing discipline bridging the physical and social sciences. Originating from the Greek roots **Geo** (the Earth) and **Graphein** (to write or describe), it studies the Earth as the home of humankind. Geography is inherently **synthetic, empirical, and practical**, investigating spatial distributions, territorial variations, and reciprocal human-nature interactions.

Modern geographic inquiry addresses three fundamental analytical questions:

1. **What:** Identification and cataloguing of natural and cultural features across the Earth's surface.
2. **Where:** Spatial distribution and territorial mapping of these phenomena.
3. **Why / How:** Causal explanations connecting physical nature with human cultural adaptations.

CORE NATURE OF GEOGRAPHY

- **Integrative:** Synthesizes inputs from physical sciences (geology, meteorology) and social sciences (economics, sociology, demography, political science).
- **Spatial Science:** Focuses on spatial attributes—location, distance, orientation, and territorial organization.
- **Dynamic:** Acknowledges that both the physical Earth and human societies are in unceasing transformation.

1.2 Dualism in Geography: The Great Methodological Debates

The history of geographic thought is characterized by recurring dichotomies:

- **Physical vs. Human Geography:** Physical geography investigates abiotic and biotic systems (geomorphology, climatology, hydrology, biogeography), whereas human geography analyzes the spatial organization of human activities and cultural landscapes.
- **Systematic vs. Regional Geography:** Introduced by **Bernhardus Varenius** and elaborated by **Alexander von Humboldt** (Systematic) and **Carl Ritter** (Regional). Systematic geography studies a single phenomenon globally across all continents, while regional geography provides a holistic synthesis of a bounded territorial unit.
- **Nomothetic vs. Idiographic: Nomothetic** (law-seeking) strives to formulate universal scientific laws and quantitative models (the Quantitative Revolution). **Idiographic** (descriptive) emphasizes unique historical and cultural regional personalities (**Areal Differentiation**).
- **Dichotomy vs. Continuum:** Contemporary geography treats these dualisms as complementary poles of a unified continuum.

1.3 Organic and Anatomical Metaphors in Geographic Analysis

To bridge the divide between nature and society, geographers employ biological and anatomical metaphors:

- **Anatomical Toponyms:** Geographers speak of the **"face of the earth"**, **"eye of the cyclone"**, **"mouth of the river"**, **"snout of the glacier"**, **"neck of the isthmus"**, and the **"profile of the soil"**.
- **Circulatory & Nervous Networks:** Transport ribbons (highways, railways, waterways) and telecommunications are analyzed as **"arteries, veins, and nerves"** circulating goods, passengers, and ideas.
- **The Organismic Theory of the State:** German geographer **Friedrich Ratzel** conceptualized the state as a living organism. Just as an organism requires nourishment to sustain vitality, a vigorous state requires territorial living space (**Lebensraum**) to survive and grow.

1.4 Authoritative Definitions of Human Geography

NCERT Class 12 establishes three cardinal benchmark definitions frequently tested in CUET UG:

""Human geography is the synthetic study of relationship between human societies and earth's surface.""

- **CUET Keyword: Synthesis** between human societies and terrestrial environment.

""Human geography is the study of 'the changing relationship between the unresting man and the unstable earth'.""

- **CUET Keywords: Dynamism**, the **"unresting man"** and the **"unstable earth"**.

""Conception resulting from a more synthetic knowledge of the physical laws governing our earth and of the relations between the living beings which inhabit it.""

- **CUET Keywords: Synthetic knowledge** uniting physical laws and ecological relationships.

Geographer	Core Intellectual Anchor	Verbatim CUET Memory Key
Friedrich Ratzel (Germany)	Synthetic Study of Spatial Relations	**Synthesis** between societies and Earth's surface.
Ellen Churchill Semple (USA)	Dynamic, Restless Interaction	Changing relationship between **unresting man** and **unstable earth**.
Paul Vidal de la Blache (France)	Ecological Interdependence	Synthetic knowledge of **physical laws** and **living beings**.

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Module 2: Naturalisation of Humans & Humanisation of Nature

2.1 Environmental Determinism: The Naturalisation of Humans

In early human history, low technological development and simple social structures rendered human beings passive subjects of physical forces. This ecological state is termed the **Naturalisation of Humans** or **Environmental Determinism**.

THE STATE OF NECESSITY

Primitive human existence was a **State of Necessity**. Lacking advanced tools, humans could not modify climate or terrain; survival required total submission, reverence, and fear of nature. Natural elements (sun, thunder, rain, forests) were deified as **Mother Nature**.

Hallmarks of Environmental Determinism:

1. **Technological Primitivity:** Simple implements of stone, bone, or wood; reliance on food gathering, hunting, and shifting cultivation.
2. **Sacredness & Taboos:** Nature is viewed as an active deity; ecological balance is maintained through religious awe.
3. **Low Carrying Capacity:** Population size is strictly limited by seasonal biomass availability.

NCERT Benchmark Case: Benda of Abujh Maad (Central India)

- Benda lives in the deep tropical deciduous forests of Abujh Maad (Bastar, Chhattisgarh).
- Sustained directly by nature: drinks from mountain streams (**pahi**), gathers wild roots and mahua flowers, and practices **penda** (traditional shifting cultivation) with simple digging sticks.
- When stepping on moist soil beneath Sal trees, he offers prayers of gratitude to **Loi-Lug** (forest spirit). Benda represents complete harmony within the **State of Necessity**.

2.2 Possibilism: The Humanisation of Nature

As societies developed scientific knowledge, they transcended environmental constraints. This transition is termed the **Humanisation of Nature** or **Possibilism**, pioneered by French historian **Lucian Febvre**: ""There are no necessities, but everywhere possibilities; and man, as a master of these possibilities, is the judge of their use.""

Under Possibilism, nature acts as a cooperative partner offering latent resources. Humankind applies technology to create the **cultural landscape**.

TECHNOLOGY DECODES NATURAL LAWS

Technology reflects a society's intellectual maturity:

- **Friction and heat** unlocked the mastery of **fire**.
- **DNA and genetics** unlocked modern **biotechnology** and disease cures.
- **Aerodynamic lift** enabled supersonic aviation and space travel.

NCERT Benchmark Case: Kari of Trondheim (Norway)

- In sub-Arctic Trondheim, outdoor winter temperatures plunge below −20°C with severe snowstorms.
- Kari works in a climate-controlled glass tower at a pleasant 23°C, eats fresh strawberries grown in artificial hydroponic greenhouses, and interacts globally via satellite telecommunications.
- Kari's life represents the **State of Freedom**—the complete **Humanisation of Nature**.

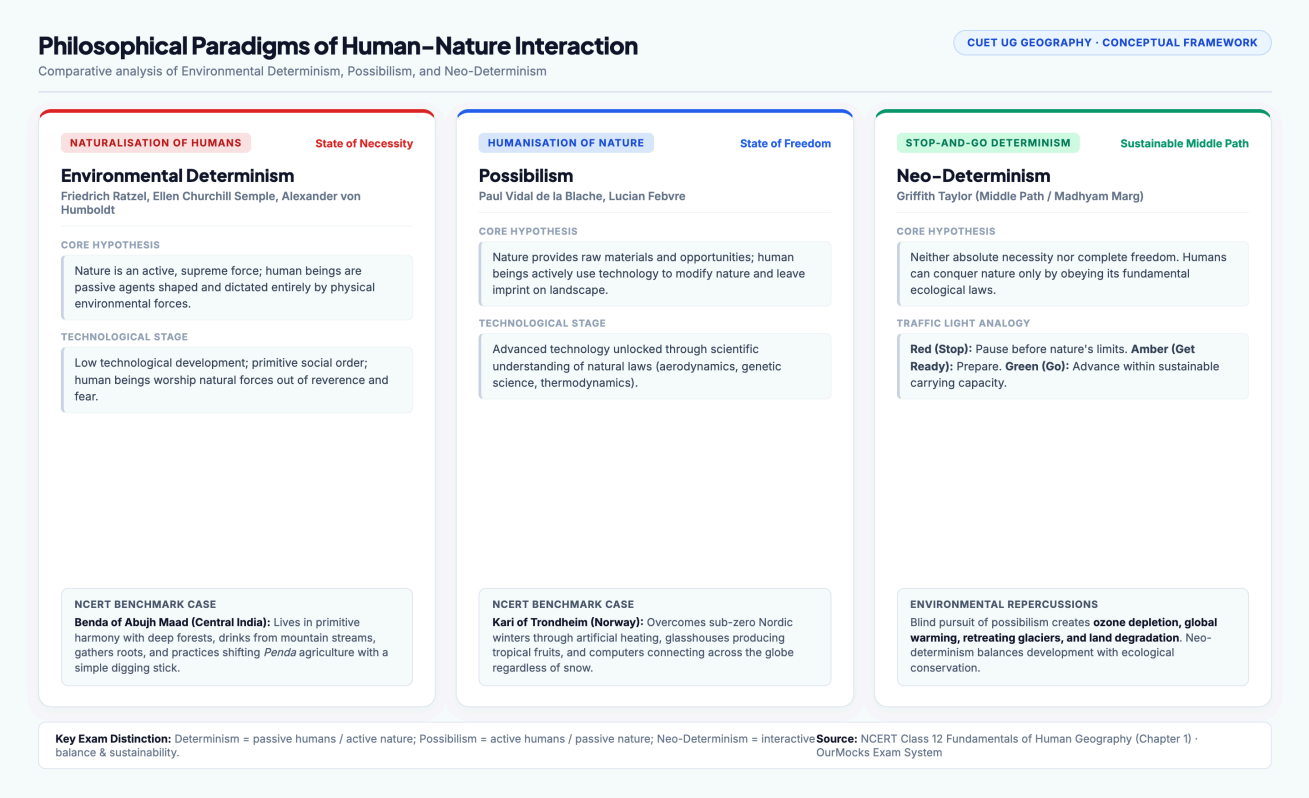


Figure 1: Comparative Matrix of Environmental Determinism, Possibilism, and Neo-Determinism

2.3 Neo-Determinism: Stop-and-Go Determinism (Sustainable Middle Path)

Unchecked Possibilism unleashed severe crises: stratospheric ozone depletion, global warming, receding glaciers, desertification, and biodiversity loss. In response, Australian geographer **Griffith Taylor** formulated **Neo-Determinism** or **Stop-and-Go Determinism**.

THE ESSENCE OF NEO-DETERMINISM

Neo-Determinism is a **Middle Path** (**Madhyam Marg**) rejecting both absolute necessity and absolute freedom:

- Humans can alter the rate, but not the ultimate direction, of progress.
- Humankind conquers nature only by obeying its non-negotiable ecological laws.

The Traffic Light Analogy:

- **Red Light (Stop):** Pause development when environmental thresholds are breached (e.g., desertification, over-drafted aquifers).
- **Amber Light (Prepare):** Monitor carrying capacity, conduct environmental assessments, and develop green alternatives.
- **Green Light (Go):** Advance development within sustainable ecological carrying limits.

Feature	Determinism	Possibilism	Neo-Determinism
Key Thinkers	Ratzel, Semple, Humboldt	Vidal de la Blache, Febvre	Griffith Taylor

Feature	Determinism	Possibilism	Neo-Determinism
Human Role	Passive subject; fearful.	Active modifier; master.	Pragmatic traffic regulator.
Nature Role	Supreme deity and master.	Passive palette of options.	Ecological threshold setter.
Core State	**State of Necessity**	**State of Freedom**	**Sustainable Middle Path**
NCERT Case	Benda of Abujh Maad	Kari of Trondheim	Sustainable Development

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Module 3: Human Geography Through the Corridors of Time

3.1 The Historical Trajectory of Disciplinary Paradigms

Human Geography evolved across distinct historical epochs in response to geopolitical and intellectual revolutions (NCERT Table 1.1).

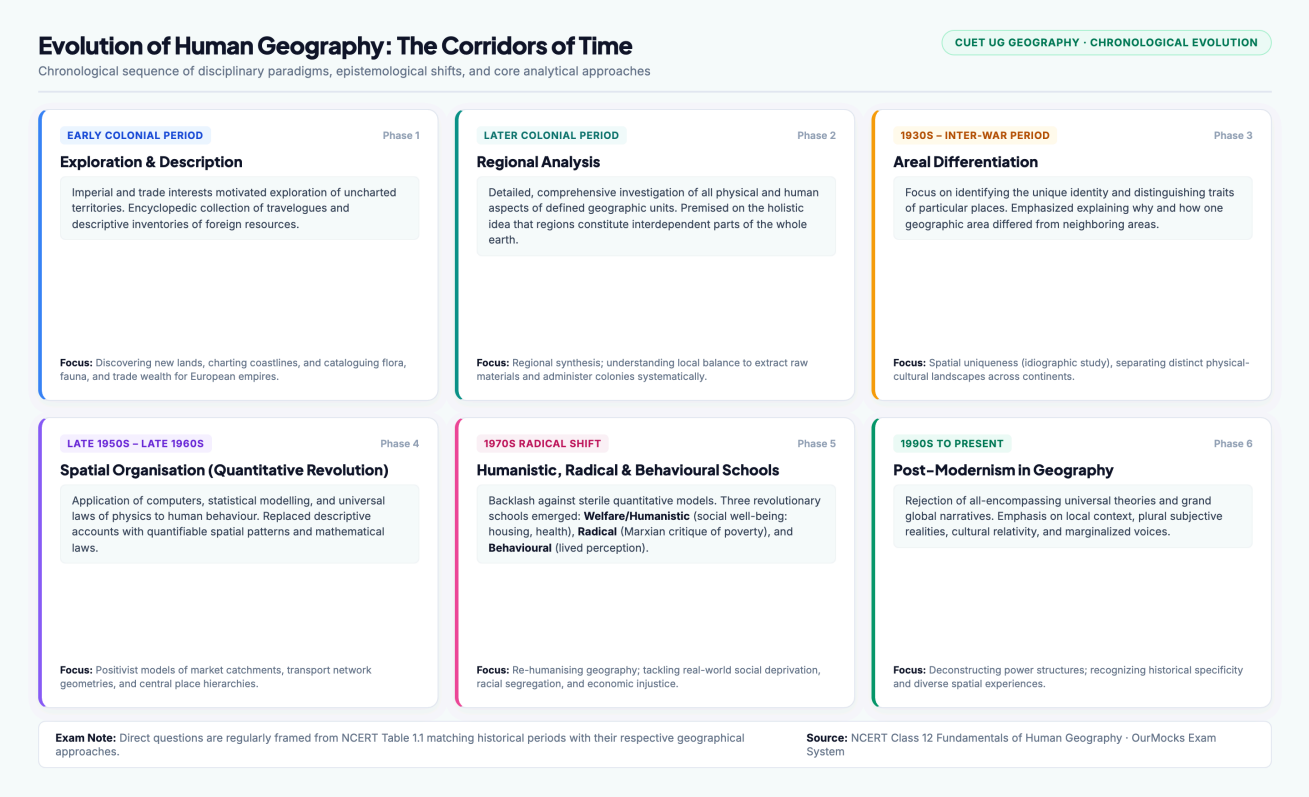


Figure 2: Evolutionary Sequence of Paradigms from Early Colonial Exploration to Post-Modernism

3.2 Deep Analysis of the Six Historical Periods

1. **Early Colonial Period (Exploration & Description):**

- Motivated by imperial trade discovery (Age of Discovery). Explorers mapped uncharted coasts and compiled encyclopedic inventories of flora, fauna, and mineral wealth.

2. **Later Colonial Period (Regional Analysis):**
   - Elaborate regional monographs were compiled based on the holistic philosophy that every region is an organic component of the planetary whole. This knowledge aided colonial administration and resource extraction.
3. **1930s through Inter-War Period (Areal Differentiation):**
   - Championed by **Richard Hartshorne**. Emphasized the unique personality of particular regions (**idiographic approach**), investigating why and how one geographic area differed from another.
4. **Late 1950s to Late 1960s (Spatial Organisation & Quantitative Revolution):**
   - Replaced qualitative regionalism with computer modeling, statistical laws, and geometric physics analogues (Christaller, Von Thünen). Human behavior was modeled on the rational **Economic Man** (**Homo economicus**).
5. **1970s Radical Backlash (Welfare, Radical, and Behavioural Schools):**
   - Disillusionment with sterile mathematical formulas that failed to address war, poverty, and urban ghettos led to three revolutionary schools focused on human well-being, Marxian analysis, and cognitive perception.
6. **1990s to Present (Post-Modernism in Geography):**
   - Rejection of all-encompassing universal theories ("meta-narratives"). Focus on localized narratives, cultural relativity, plural voices, and the deconstruction of spatial power structures.

Period	Dominant Approach	Core Focus & Methods
Early Colonial	Exploration & Description	Imperial discovery; encyclopedic inventories of trade goods and lands.
Later Colonial	Regional Analysis	Holistic regional monographs; part-to-whole planetary synthesis.
1930s Inter-War	Areal Differentiation	Uncovering uniqueness of specific places; idiographic regional study.
Late 1950s–1960s	Spatial Organisation (QR)	Application of mathematics, physics laws, and statistical modeling.
1970s	Welfare, Radical, Behavioural	Anti-quantitative shift; social justice, Marxian critique, lived perception.
1990s–Present	Post-Modernism	Rejection of grand universal theories; localized context and pluralism.

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Module 4: The 1970s Radical Epistemological Triad

4.1 The Welfare or Humanistic School

- **Core Ethos:** Geography must address human suffering and promote social well-being.
- **David M. Smith's Famous Maxim: "Who gets what, where, and how?"**
  - **Who:** Identifies the population subgroup (by class, caste, ethnicity, gender).
  - **What:** The bundle of social goods (housing, clean water, healthcare, education).
  - **Where:** The geographical location (rural periphery, inner-city slum, wealthy suburb).
  - **How:** The institutional and economic mechanisms causing or relieving spatial disparities.
- **Humanistic Focus: Yi-Fu Tuan** emphasized human agency, consciousness, and emotional bonding with places (**topophilia**).

4.2 The Radical (Marxian) School

- **Analytical Base:** Marxian political economy and historical materialism.
- **Core Argument:** Poverty, slum creation, and regional underdevelopment are not natural accidents of geography; they are **structural outcomes of the capitalist mode of production**.
- **Key Thinkers: David Harvey** (**Social Justice and the City**, 1973) and **Richard Peet**. They advocated praxis and social revolution to overthrow exploitative capitalist property relations.

4.3 The Behavioural School

- **Analytical Base:** Cognitive psychology and decision theory.
- **Critique of QR:** Rejected the concept of the omniscient, hyper-rational **Economic Man**.
- **Key Principles:**
  - Humans act upon their **perceived environment** (mental maps) rather than objective physical reality.
  - Decision-making operates under **bounded rationality** (satisficing rather than maximizing).
  - Spatial choices are heavily filtered by **social identity** (gender, ethnicity, race, and religion).

1970s School	Primary Theoretical Base	Core Focus & Key Thinkers
Welfare / Humanistic	Welfare Economics, Phenomenology	Social well-being (housing, health). **"Who gets what, where, how?"** David Smith, Yi-Fu Tuan.
Radical School	Marxian Theory & Historical Materialism	Poverty and spatial inequality caused by capitalism. David Harvey, Richard Peet.

1970s School	Primary Theoretical Base	Core Focus & Key Thinkers
Behavioural School	Cognitive Psychology	Mental maps, perception, bounded rationality, and social identity. William Kirk, Julian Wolpert.

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Module 5: Fields, Sub-Fields & Interdisciplinary Linkages

5.1 The Taxonomy of Human Geography (NCERT Table 1.2)

Human Geography maintains close, interdisciplinary links with sister social sciences.

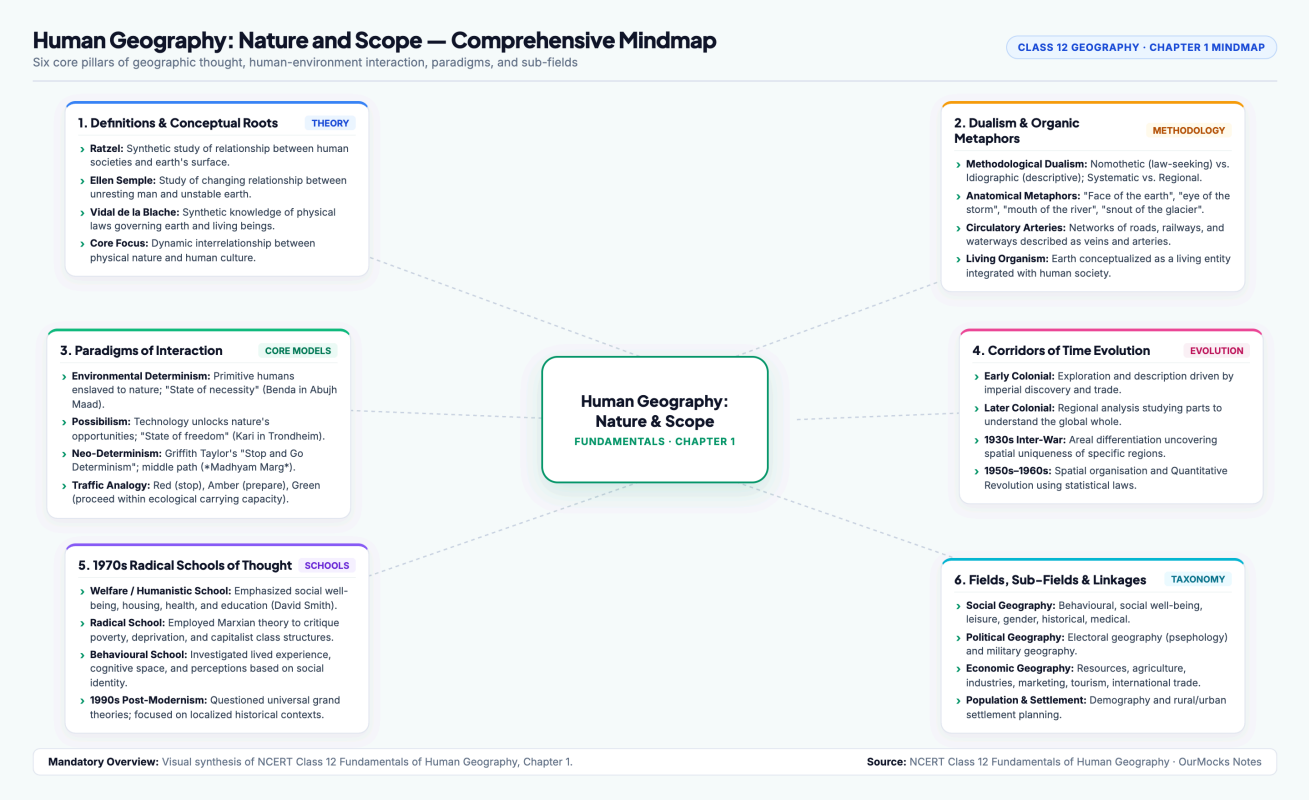


Figure 3: Mindmap of Human Geography: Nature, Epistemology, Corridors of Time, and Sub-fields

5.2 Fields, Sub-Fields & Sister Disciplines Reference Table

Primary Field	Specialized Sub-Field	Corresponding Sister Discipline
Social Geography	Behavioural Geography	Psychology
Social Geography	Geography of Social Well-being	Welfare Economics
Social Geography	Geography of Leisure	Sociology

Primary Field	Specialized Sub-Field	Corresponding Sister Discipline
Social Geography	Cultural Geography	Anthropology
Social Geography	Gender Geography	Sociology, Anthropology, Women's Studies
Social Geography	Historical Geography	History
Social Geography	Medical Geography	Epidemiology / Public Health
Urban Geography	Urban Land Use & Morphology	Urban Studies and Urban Planning
Political Geography	Electoral Geography (Psephology)	Political Science
Political Geography	Military Geography	Military Science / Strategic Studies
Population Geography	Demographic Geography	Demography
Settlement Geography	Rural & Urban Settlement Systems	Urban and Rural Planning
Economic Geography	Geography of Resources	Resource Economics
Economic Geography	Geography of Agriculture	Agricultural Sciences
Economic Geography	Geography of Industries	Industrial Economics
Economic Geography	Geography of Marketing	Business Studies, Commerce
Economic Geography	Geography of Tourism	Tourism & Travel Management
Economic Geography	Geography of International Trade	International Economics

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Module 6: High-Yield CUET Comparison Tables & Concept Synthesis

6.1 Epistemological Comparison: The Great Paradigms

Criteria	Environmental Determinism	Possibilism	Neo-Determinism
Core Axiom	Nature dictates and shapes human culture.	Nature offers opportunities; humans shape culture.	Humans progress within ecological limits.

Criteria	Environmental Determinism	Possibilism	Neo-Determinism
Human Role	Subordinate, passive, fearful.	Active, creative modifier, master.	Pragmatic traffic regulator.
Nature Role	Supreme master and creator.	Passive palette of latent options.	Active ecological threshold setter.
Key Slogan	**State of Necessity**	**State of Freedom**	**Stop-and-Go Determinism**
Primary Thinker	Friedrich Ratzel, E.C. Semple	Paul Vidal de la Blache, Lucian Febvre	Griffith Taylor
Benchmark Case	Benda of Abujh Maad (Central India)	Kari of Trondheim (Norway)	Sustainable Development & Carbon Budgets
Modern Pitfall	Fatalistic paralysis.	Severe ecological collapse.	Requires strict global green policy.

6.2 Key Geographers and Disciplinary Milestones

Geographer & Origin	Major Work / Concept	Core Contribution
Friedrich Ratzel (Germany)	**Anthropogeographie**, **Lebensraum**	Defined synthetic study; conceptualized state as living organism.
Ellen Churchill Semple (USA)	**Influences of Geographic Environment**	Dynamic definition: **unresting man** and **unstable earth**.
Paul Vidal de la Blache (France)	**Principles of Human Geography**	Pioneered French Possibilism and cultural landscapes.
Lucian Febvre (France)	**A Geographical Introduction to History**	Coined the term **Possibilism**; "there are no necessities…"
Griffith Taylor (Australia/USA)	**Stop-and-Go Determinism**	Formulated **Neo-Determinism** and the traffic light analogy.
Richard Hartshorne (USA)	**The Nature of Geography** (1939)	Championed **Areal Differentiation** as core regional method.
David M. Smith (UK)	**Where the Grass is Greener** (1979)	Pioneered the Welfare School: **"Who gets what, where, how?"**.
David Harvey (UK/USA)	**Social Justice and the City** (1973)	Pioneered the Marxian Radical School in Human Geography.

Module 7: Master Revision Cheatsheet & Epistemological Synthesis

MASTER REVISION MATRIX — HUMAN GEOGRAPHY: PARADIGMS, THINKERS & CORRIDORS OF TIME

Epoch / Approach	Core Defining Thinkers	Key Geographical Concepts & Axioms
Early Colonial Period	Imperial Explorers & Cartographers	Exploration and Description: Mapping newly discovered coasts and encyclopedic inventories of tradeable commodities.
Later Colonial Period	Colonial Surveyors & Naturalists	Regional Analysis: Holistic study of a region as an integrated part of the global organism; elaborate descriptions.
1930s (Inter-War Period)	Richard Hartshorne, Alfred Hettner	Areal Differentiation: Identifying what makes each geographic region unique and different from other areas.
Late 1950s – Late 1960s	Quantitative Spatial Scientists	Spatial Organisation (Quantitative Revolution): Application of universal physics laws, geometry, and statistical models; treating humans as rational **Homo economicus**.
1970s Radical School	David Harvey (**Social Justice and the City**)	Marxian theory applied to spatial inequality: Poverty, deprivation, and urban slums are direct structural outcomes of capitalism.
1970s Welfare / Humanistic	David M. Smith (**Where the Grass is Greener**)	Welfare Geography: Focus on social well-being, healthcare, education, housing, and **"Who gets what, where, and how?"**.
1970s Behavioural School	Julian Wolpert, Yi-Fu Tuan	Cognitive perception, mental maps, and human lived experience; spatial behavior is governed by subjective perception, not geometric optimization.
1990s Post-Modernism	Post-modern social theorists	Rejection of universal meta-narratives; questioning global theories; local context, pluralistic voices, and historic specificity.
Environmental Determinism	Friedrich Ratzel (**Anthropogeographie**), E.C. Semple	**Naturalisation of Humans**: Primitive technology forces absolute subservience to nature; **"State of Necessity"**; Benda of Abujh Maad case.
Possibilism	Paul Vidal de la Blache, Lucian Febvre	**Humanisation of Nature**: Technology transforms constraints into latent opportunities; **"State of Freedom"**; Kari of Trondheim case.
Neo-Determinism	Griffith Taylor (**Stop-and-Go Determinism**)	Pragmatic middle path: Nature sets traffic-light boundaries; humans accelerate/pause but cannot subvert ecological laws.

THE ORGANIC & ANATOMICAL TOPONYMY OF GEOGRAPHY

- **Metaphorical Body of the Earth:** Geographers anthropomorphize nature by identifying the **face of the earth**, **eye of the storm**, **mouth of the river**, **snout of a glacier**, **neck of the isthmus**, and **profile of soil**.
- **Organic Concept of the State:** Friedrich Ratzel famously described the sovereign nation-state as a **living physical organism**, whose territory represents its bodily frame and borders represent its living skin requiring expansion (**Lebensraum**).
- **Transport Arteries:** Networks of railways, roadways, waterways, and optical-fiber conduits are universally conceptualized as **arteries and veins of circulation** sustaining the economic organism.

Module 8: The Seven Fatal CUET Traps & Diagnostic Rules

THE SEVEN FATAL CUET EXAM TRAPS IN HUMAN GEOGRAPHY

The Trap Concept	The Common Student Slip	The Exact NCERT / NTA Rule
1. Ratzel vs Semple Definition	Confusing Ratzel's and Semple's definitions of Human Geography.	Ratzel's keyword is **synthetic study** (**Anthropogeographie**). Semple's keyword is **changing relationship between unresting man and unstable earth**.
2. Coining vs Championing Possibilism	Crediting Vidal de la Blache with coining the term Possibilism.	Historian **Lucian Febvre** coined the word "Possibilism" (**"There are no necessities..."**). Vidal de la Blache was its primary geographic champion.
3. Red Light vs Green Light Meaning	Assuming red light means "permanent prohibition" of human development.	Taylor's red light means **stop/pause and obey natural limits** (do not destroy ecology). Green light means **go ahead within carrying capacity**.
4. 1970s Triad Distinctions	Mixing up the philosophical drivers of the 1970s triad of schools.	Radical = **Marxian structural critique of capitalism**; Welfare = **Social well-being & distribution**; Behavioural = **Cognitive perception & mental maps**.
5. Spatial Organisation Era	Assigning the Quantitative Revolution to the 1970s or 1990s.	Spatial Organisation (computer models, statistical laws) strictly peaked during the **Late 1950s to Late 1960s**!
6. Dualism & Dichotomy Nature	Believing physical geography and human geography are irreconcilably separate.	NCERT emphasizes that nature and human beings are **inseparable elements** and must be studied holistically as an organic whole.
7. Natural Law Prerequisite	Assuming technology can be developed without understanding natural physical laws.	Friction and heat laws led to **fire**; DNA/genetics led to **curing disease**; aerodynamics laws led to **faster aircraft**! Technology requires prior natural law mastery.

HIGH-FREQUENCY CUET UG TESTING PATTERNS

- **Chronological Match-the-Following:** Always memorize NCERT Table 1.1 in chronological order: Exploration (Early Colonial) → Regional Analysis (Later Colonial) → Areal Differentiation (1930s Inter-War) → Spatial Organisation (Late 1950s–1960s) → Radical, Behavioural, Welfare Triad (1970s) → Post-Modernism (1990s).
- **Philosophical Paradigm Pairings:** Match environmental determinism with "state of necessity" (Benda), possibilism with "state of freedom" (Kari), and neo-determinism with "stop-and-go" (Taylor).

Module 9: CUET UG Practice Questions — Part 1 (Q1 to Q5)

Q1. Who defined Human Geography as the **"synthetic study of relationship between human societies and earth's surface"**?

(A) Ellen Churchill Semple
(B) Friedrich Ratzel
(C) Paul Vidal de la Blache
(D) Griffith Taylor

Sol. Q1. Friedrich Ratzel, in his work **Anthropogeographie**, defined human geography as the "synthetic study of relationship between human societies and earth's surface." The defining keyword for Ratzel is **synthesis**.
Answer: (B)

Q2. Ellen Churchill Semple's definition of Human Geography explicitly emphasizes the dynamic relationship between which two entities?

(A) Sovereign states and bounded territories
(B) Rational economic actors and market geometries
(C) Unresting man and unstable earth
(D) Technological innovations and cultural landscapes

Sol. Q2. Ellen Churchill Semple defined human geography as the study of "the changing relationship between the unresting man and the unstable earth," emphasizing dynamic, continuous reciprocal interaction.
Answer: (C)

Q3. Which philosophical concept describes the primitive stage of human society characterized by low technological development and complete subjugation to physical nature?

(A) Humanisation of Nature
(B) Naturalisation of Humans
(C) Neo-Determinism
(D) Areal Differentiation

Sol. Q3. The **Naturalisation of Humans** (Environmental Determinism) describes the primitive stage where lack of technology forced humans to live in a "state of necessity", worshipping nature out of awe and fear.
Answer: (B)

Q4. In NCERT Class 12 Fundamentals of Human Geography, the case study of **Benda** of Abujh Maad (Central India) is an empirical illustration of which concept?

(A) Possibilism and advanced micro-climates
(B) Neo-Determinism and ecological traffic regulation
(C) Naturalisation of Humans (Environmental Determinism)
(D) The Quantitative Revolution

Sol. Q4. Benda's subsistence forest life in Abujh Maad illustrates the **Naturalisation of Humans**. He lives in harmony with his forest environment, gathering forest produce and practicing simple **penda** cultivation.
Answer: (C)

Q5. Who among the following thinkers coined the famous dictum: **"There are no necessities, but everywhere possibilities; and man, as a master of these possibilities, is the judge of their use"**?

(A) Paul Vidal de la Blache
(B) Alexander von Humboldt
(C) Lucian Febvre
(D) Griffith Taylor

Sol. Q5. French historian **Lucian Febvre** coined this famous phrase in **A Geographical Introduction to History** (1925), formally introducing the term **Possibilism**.
Answer: (C)

Practice Questions — Part 2 (Q6 to Q10)

Q6. Which technological breakthrough is correctly paired with the underlying natural law that humankind had to discover and master before developing that technology?

(A) Aviation and aeroplanes → Laws of DNA and genetics
(B) Mastery of fire → Concepts of friction and heat
(C) Eradication of infectious diseases → Laws of aerodynamics
(D) Supersonic jet engines → Principles of plant hybridization

Sol. Q6. NCERT notes that technology advances through decoding natural laws: friction and heat led to the discovery of fire; genetics led to curing diseases; and aerodynamics led to aviation.
Answer: (B)

Q7. The lifestyle of **Kari of Trondheim** (Norway), who works in a heated building in sub-zero winter temperatures and eats fresh strawberries grown in greenhouses, is a classic demonstration of:

(A) Environmental Determinism
(B) The Humanisation of Nature (Possibilism)
(C) Nomothetic Areal Differentiation
(D) The state of absolute primitive necessity

Sol. Q7. Kari's lifestyle exemplifies the **Humanisation of Nature** (Possibilism), where modern science and technology overcome sub-zero arctic winters to create artificial, comfortable micro-climates.
Answer: (B)

Q8. The concept of **Neo-Determinism** or **Stop-and-Go Determinism** was formulated by which geographer as a sustainable middle path between Environmental Determinism and Possibilism?

(A) Carl Sauer
(B) Richard Hartshorne
(C) Griffith Taylor
(D) David M. Smith

Sol. Q8. Griffith Taylor formulated **Neo-Determinism** (Stop-and-Go Determinism). He argued that humans can accelerate or guide progress, but only by strictly respecting the carrying capacity of nature.
Answer: (C)

Q9. In Griffith Taylor's famous traffic light analogy for Neo-Determinism, what does the **Red Light** signify?

(A) Accelerating industrial development regardless of resource costs
(B) Complete freedom to alter natural ecosystems
(C) Pausing and stopping when nature's limits and carrying capacities are approached
(D) The final abandonment of all scientific technology

Sol. Q9. The **Red Light** means "Stop". It warns human societies to pause when approaching non-negotiable ecological limits (e.g., desertification, ozone depletion) before catastrophic collapse occurs.
Answer: (C)

Q10. Match the historical period in the evolution of Human Geography with its dominant approach:

1. Early Colonial Period → (i) Spatial Organisation (Quantitative Revolution)
2. 1930s through Inter-War Period → (ii) Exploration and Description
3. Late 1950s to Late 1960s → (iii) Areal Differentiation
4. 1990s to Present → (iv) Post-Modernism in Geography

(A) 1-(ii), 2-(iii), 3-(i), 4-(iv)
(B) 1-(iii), 2-(ii), 3-(iv), 4-(i)
(C) 1-(ii), 2-(i), 3-(iii), 4-(iv)
(D) 1-(iv), 2-(iii), 3-(i), 4-(ii)

Sol. Q10. According to NCERT Table 1.1: Early Colonial = Exploration & Description (ii); 1930s Inter-War = Areal Differentiation (iii); Late 1950s–1960s = Spatial Organisation (i); 1990s to Present = Post-Modernism (iv).
Answer: (A)

Practice Questions — Part 3 (Q11 to Q15)

Q11. Which 1970s school of geographical thought utilized **Marxian theory** to explain that poverty and regional inequality are structural outcomes of the capitalist mode of production?

(A) The Welfare / Humanistic School
(B) The Behavioural School
(C) The Radical School
(D) The Positivist Quantitative School

Sol. Q11. The **Radical School** employed Marxian theory and historical materialism to prove that poverty, slum creation, and uneven development are structural consequences of capitalist accumulation.
Answer: (C)

Q12. The **Behavioural School** in Human Geography launched a major critique against the Quantitative Revolution by arguing that:

(A) Universal geometric laws can perfectly predict all human actions.
(B) Human actions are dictated by cognitive perception, mental maps, and social identity rather than rational economic optimization.
(C) Only physical geomorphology represents true scientific geography.
(D) Capitalism should be preserved through statistical modeling.

Sol. Q12. The **Behavioural School** rejected the unrealistic model of **Homo economicus** (rational economic man), proving that spatial actions are mediated by mental maps, perception, and social identities.
Answer: (B)

Q13. The geographic inquiry into **"Who gets what, where, and how?"** is the philosophical hallmark of which school of thought?

(A) Environmental Determinism
(B) The Welfare or Humanistic School
(C) Quantitative Spatial Science
(D) Exploration and Description

Sol. Q13. David M. Smith and the **Welfare / Humanistic School** made **"Who gets what, where, and how?"** their central question, focusing on the equitable spatial distribution of social well-being.
Answer: (B)

Q14. According to NCERT Table 1.2 (**Fields and Sub-fields of Human Geography**), the specialized sub-field of **Electoral Geography** directly interfaces with which sister discipline?

(A) Anthropology
(B) Sociology
(C) Demography
(D) Political Science (Psephology)

Sol. Q14. Electoral Geography interfaces directly with **Political Science**, specifically **Psephology** (the scientific study of elections, voting behavior, and constituency delimitation).
Answer: (D)

Q15. Which organic / anatomical metaphor is correctly matched with its geographical usage in human and physical geographic literature?

(A) Arteries and veins of circulation → Networks of highways, railways, and waterways
(B) Eye of the storm → Terminal snout of a mountain glacier
(C) Mouth of the river → The low-pressure center of a tropical cyclone
(D) Face of the earth → Vertical profile of agricultural soil layers

Sol. Q15. Geographers employ anatomical metaphors: networks of highways, railways, and waterways are described as the **arteries and veins** of circulation. Other terms include the eye of the storm and mouth of the river.
Answer: (A)